

| V.K. DATTA                                                                                                          | AMITABH MATTOO                                                                                                |
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| China has been prodding Pakistan and its think tanks have been advocating a policy of breaking India into 37 parts. | Border incursions have been going on for some time. I see a long-term threat but not an immediate one.        |
| Beef up India's air defences and relook its nuclear posture of no-first-use. Build up self-reliance in defence.     | We should cooperate with the Chinese wherever possible and not escalate the tensions which may lead to a war. |

started with Pakistan but now is apparent in Sri Lanka, Myanmar and Nepal. This should really worry us. My second point, its impact on the situation in the North-east, especially in Manipur and Nagaland, has worsened. They will press our vulnerability together realising that the Indian Government is desperate to keep its people in the dark as it wants to present a picture of radical improvement.

**V.K. Datta:** You may have heard that people in China were thinking that they can break India into 37 different states. So they perceive that if we apply the right pressure India will disintegrate. Our key areas of concern are Jammu and Kashmir and the North-east and both of them are mountainous regions. We need to build mountain-strike forces, increase the availability of helicopters either from the air force or within the army, build up our air capability and highlight our nuclear threshold. Our war with China won't be with a naval and an air force war; it will be on land. We wish the Chinese all the best. We like to be friends with China but let no one underestimate Indian potential. If our political establishment permits, we will deliver. ■

## G. PARTHASARATHY



Now China sees India with a huge differential of power. They are concerned whether they would be able to dominate the balance of power in Asia. China is not just a threat, it is a challenge.

China is determined to contain India. It does so by nuclear weapons' transfer to Pakistan and by improving their nuclear capabilities.

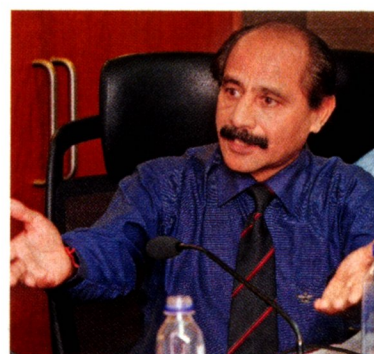
We can engage with China but we should not have any illusions, or become hysterical.

**China has maritime boundary disputes with its neighbours, so build alliances with theirs as they are doing with ours.**

## V.K. DATTA

China perceives that if we put pressure and give a little push India will disintegrate, but they are mistaken.

India shouldn't be scared of China but it must be wary of them. The Indian Army is a battle-hardened army, which the PLA is not.



**We need to build a mountain-strike force. As far as Arunachal Pradesh is concerned, the Indian Army's present capability is adequate to take on China.**

China won't undertake an operation if it has the fear of being hammered back. And if the Indian Government has the will, the army shall deliver.